

The rook cross

By C.G.S.Narayanan

The theme of the rook's cross is very popular in composition, when a white or black piece moves from its original square in all four directions by the same number of squares. A clear example of a black rook's cross in a two-mover is shown in the first diagram below with mates by the white rook along the cross.

. No. 3. M. Mylliniemi
"Pirkanmaan teht v kerho", 1972
3rd prize



Mate in two moves

Try 1.Rf1? ~ 2.Rf5, 1...d3 2.Rb1, 1.Bf2!

Try 1.c4? ~ 2.Nd7, 1...d3 2.Rc2, 1...Bxf6 2.Re1#, 1... dxc3 (e.p.)!
Try 1.b4? ~ 2.Nd7#, 1...d3 2.Rb3#, 1...c4! 1.Qa8! ~ 2.Nd7#, 1...d3 2.Ra2#, 1...Bxf6 Re1#. An unconventional realization of the white rook's cross theme and a technical execution.

The three-move genre offers much more opportunity to demonstrate rook cross mechanism than the two-mover. The Russian Grandmaster Valentin Rudenko has worked a lot fruitfully in this area. In the second diagram after 1.Bd5! the black rook is caged in, and there is a threat of 2.Nc2+ Nxc2 3.Nf3#. Black defends with the rook, freeing the e5 square for the king. At the same time, the black rook

activates the white battery, which delivers 4 precise blows.

Valentin Rudenko
I prize, Problemnoter



Mate in three moves

1...Rxe4 2.Rh7+ Re5 3.Rh4# – the 4th rank is opened, and a mate with a pin follows. 1...Rxd5 2.Rg8+ Re5 3.Rd8# now the 'd' file is opened, and again a mate with a pin. 1...Rxe6 2.Rxf7+ Re5 3.Ne6#, 2...Rf6 3.Bxf6#, 1...Rxf5 2.Rxg6+ Re5 3.Nf5#, 2...Rf6 3.Bxf6# – in the last two variations, the black rook clears the mating squares of white pieces, and the white rook destroys the black pieces controlling these squares. The mechanism works very precisely, and everything is done quite technically.

Here is a 2-move rook cross for solving
Nanning Frederick W
Tidskrift e d KNSB 1936



Mate in two moves

Solution to problem for solving in the article "Three-move Shedy cycles":-
Key 1.Qg1!

Readers may send in their queries to
cgsnarayanan@hotmail.com